Rainswept Dream

GAME301 Project 1 Game Pitch – Riku Yuki Darroch - 300606468

First, I want to Introduce Myself

Riku Yuki Darroch,

23 years old, Half Japanese, Bilingual

Chill ass viber

5th year of studying at VUW Design

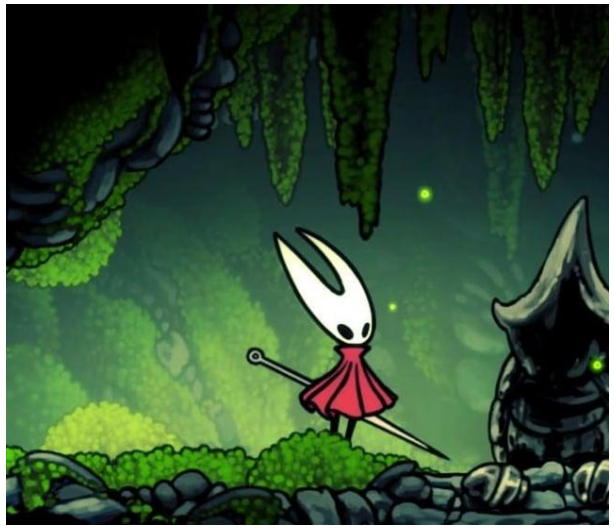
Finished my COMD last year, now back in GAME to get that Double Major

From the Deep South

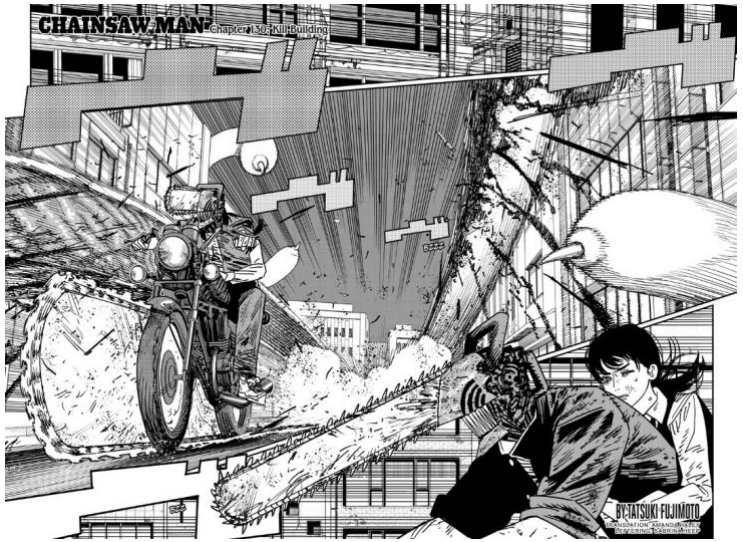
At home I have 16 game consoles

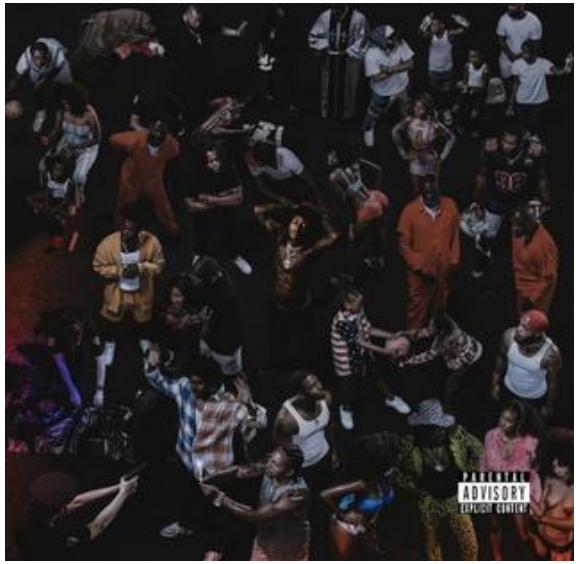
*This will be important later

Favorite Video Game Experiences

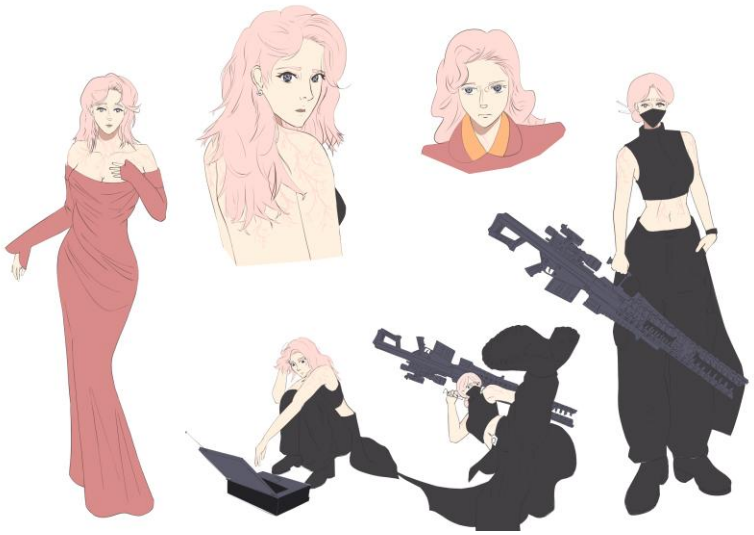


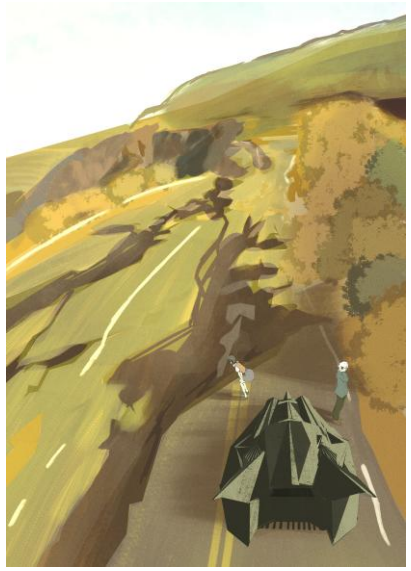
Other Things I like

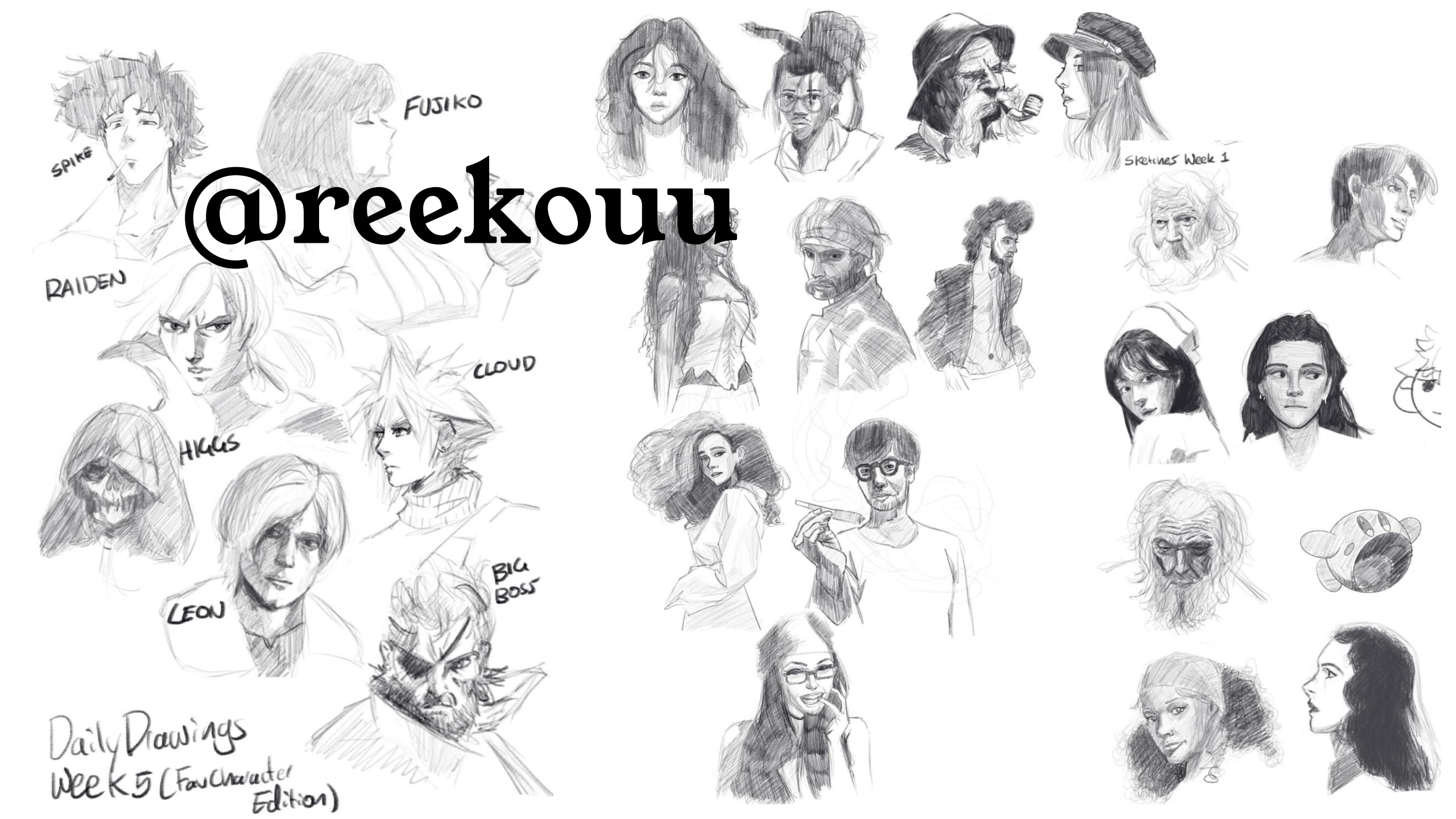




What I'm Good At






@reekouu
SPIKE
FUJIKO
RAIDEN
CLOUD
HIGGS
LEON
BIG BOSS
Daily Drawings
Week 5 (Fav Character Edition)
Sketches Week 1

Let’s be friends
:)

Rainswept Dream

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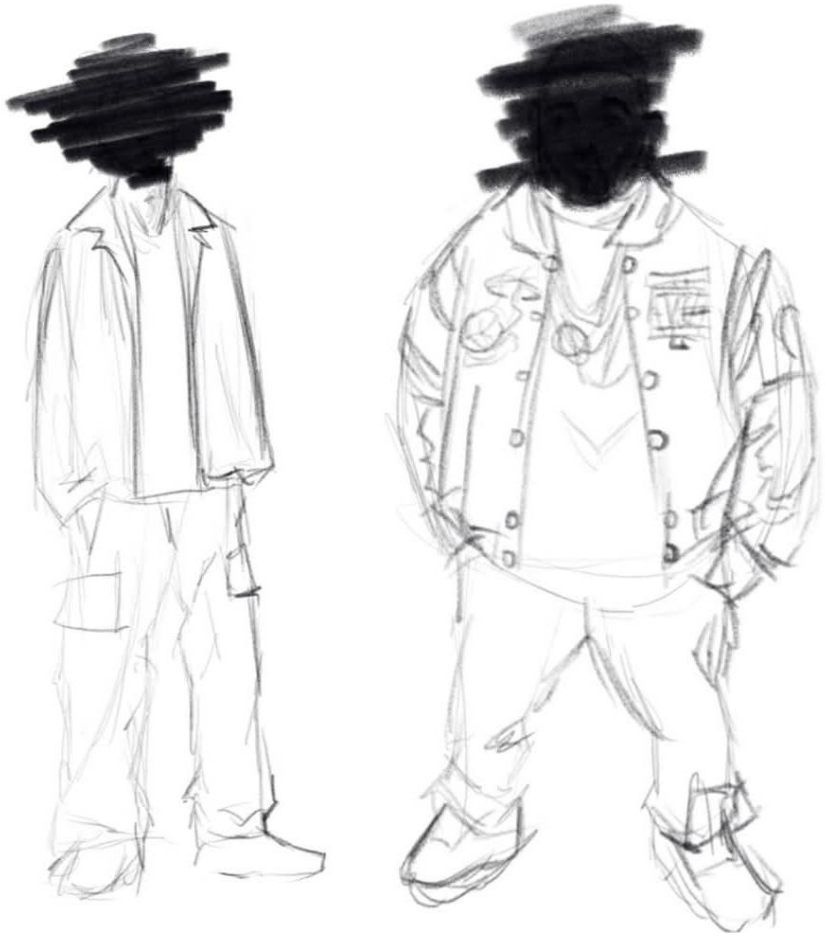
***** Content warning, Grief, Depression, Self Healing,***

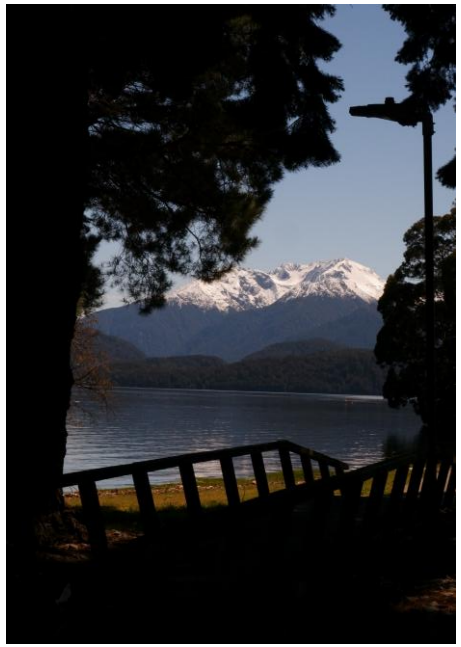
Overview

Rainswept Dream is an abstract, retro inspired horror puzzle game concept set in a looping dream. The player will explore and complete puzzles while facing embodiments of the character's insecurities before finding the key to his childhood bedroom and accepting his childhood self as a part of himself and waking up in the real world. The game has a purposefully low poly aesthetic inspired by games from the 6th console generation, with bleak, abstract and sometimes absurdist visuals that play to the narrative.

The main inspirations of this game are Silent Hill 2, Shenmue, Earthbound, Omori, and Disco Elysium.



Setting – About Te Anau



Map

Uranus - Solar System Walk
RealNZ | Te Anau Glowworm Caves
Fiordland College
Te Anau, Lake
Disc Golf Te Anau
Lake Henry Viewing Deck
Lake Henry
Te Anau Sea Scout Group
Punanga Manu o Te Anau / Te Anau...

Story

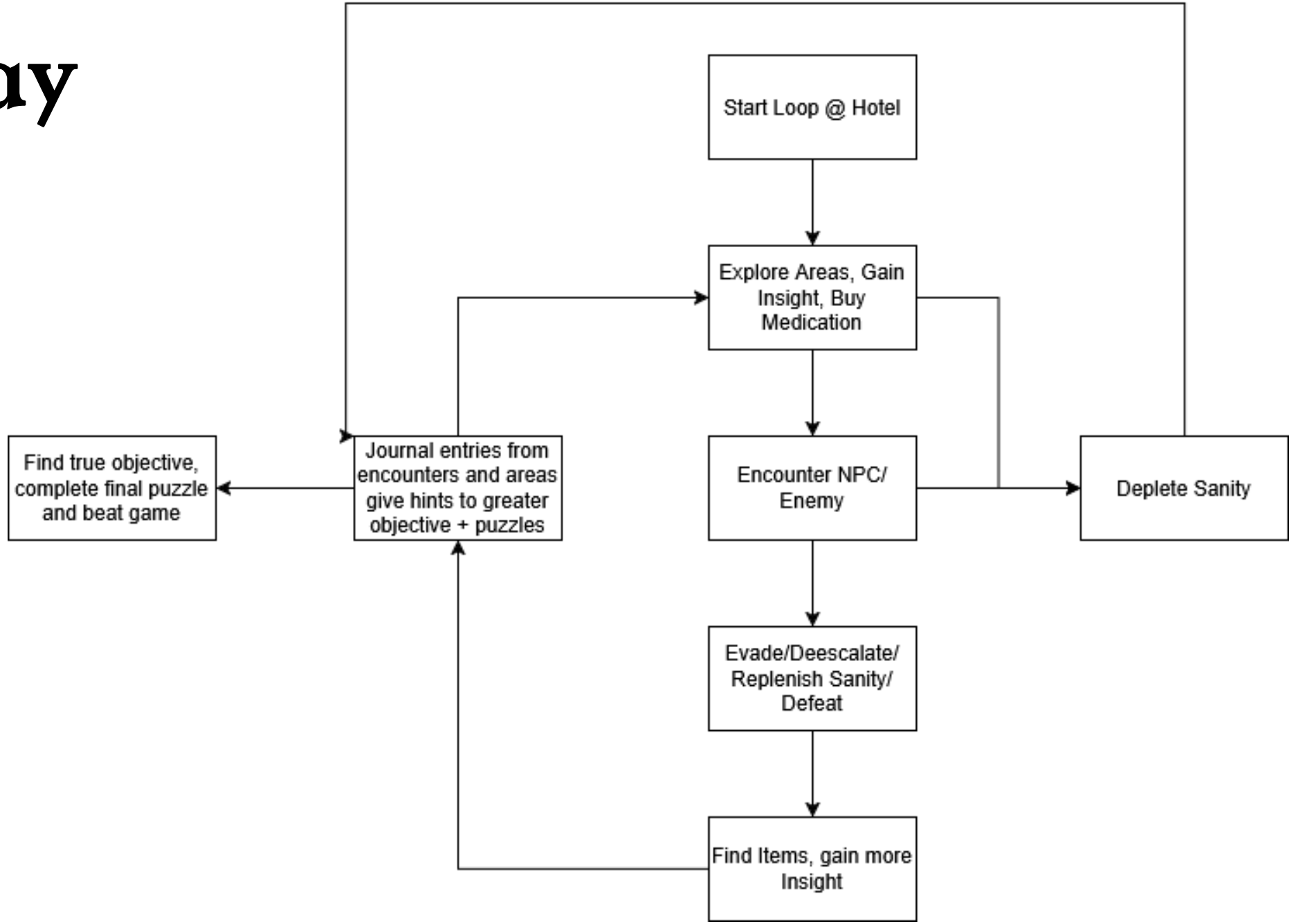
The fact that the game is set in a dream isn't told to you, rather it is insinuated through atmosphere, characters and story. The game starts with you coming back to his hometown after your parents pass away and he inherits his childhood home. However, when you the town has an unnerving and lonely atmosphere to it, no one speaks to the main character, and when they do they run out of things to say quickly.

Without purpose you wonder around this familiar but fleeting town, encountering memories and emotions long untouched, journalling them when encountered. The air is thick and burns your lungs, as if the town is dragging you back down into an abyss of depressive spiral. You remedy this by sticking to your vices smoking, taking anti-psychotic medication, before you encounter an embodiment of one of your insecurities.

Being struck down sends you to the start of the dream, bringing only with you the journal entries you have managed to scrawl down, as if the town resets back, or the day continues forward.
Slowly as you explore you come to the realization that the town is testing you, forcing you to confront your insecurities, your fears, your sadness. One by one you find a piece of you that you hid from yourself, proving to the town that you have grown, little by little. Once you have, the forest will accept you, and will return the key to your childhood room in your house.

Opening that door, you will only find yourself, a version of yourself that you once were, but locked away for a very long time while refusing to believe that he is a part of you. You apologize to him for locking him away, and you accept him as a part of yourself, breaking the loop and waking from your dream.

Gameplay


Start Loop @ Hotel
Explore Areas, Gain Insight, Buy Medication
Encounter NPC/ Enemy
Deplete Sanity
Evade/Deescalate/ Replenish Sanity/ Defeat
Find Items, gain more Insight
Journal entries from encounters and areas give hints to greater objective + puzzles
Find true objective, complete final puzzle and beat game

Gameplay

Controls are tanky, character walks slowly.

Camera fixed, but follows the player, think Silent Hill 2 or MGS1, can be wobbled.

Health System – Sanity

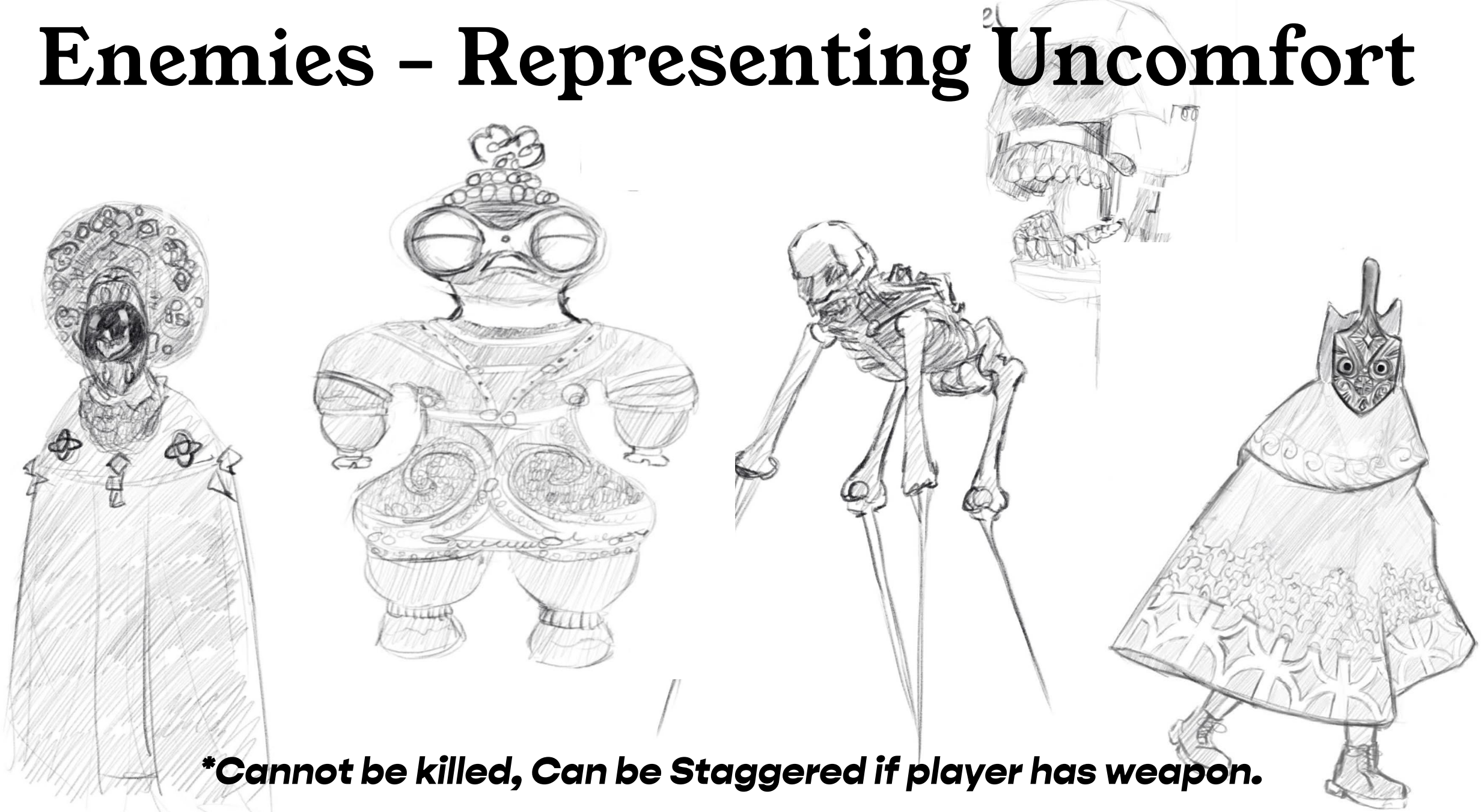
Sanity drains slowly when spending time in thick fog areas, will be damaged bluntly when attacked by enemies.

Can be replenished passively via smoking cigarette, or actively via medication

When journal entries collected, insight gained, increases sanity bar.

When Sanity reaches 0, world resets, inventory cleared and dream starts again, however Journal is carried over along with insight

Enemies - Representing Uncomfort



***Cannot be killed, Can be Staggered if player has weapon.**

Puzzle

Steal an Item from each monster, each representing an uncomfortable emotion or insecurity, and bring to an altar in the forest to prove to the forest that you have confronted your fears and retrieve the key to your childhood room

Atmosphere

As gameplay is simple, atmosphere is important to nail down in order to keep people interested in the game.

I want to play with the loneliness that 6th gen video games give when you visit an area that the story has passed on from and no one has anything to say, nothing happens.

Reminds me of home.

Insinuated by minimal non diegetic sound, minimal character lines, and minimal NPCs.

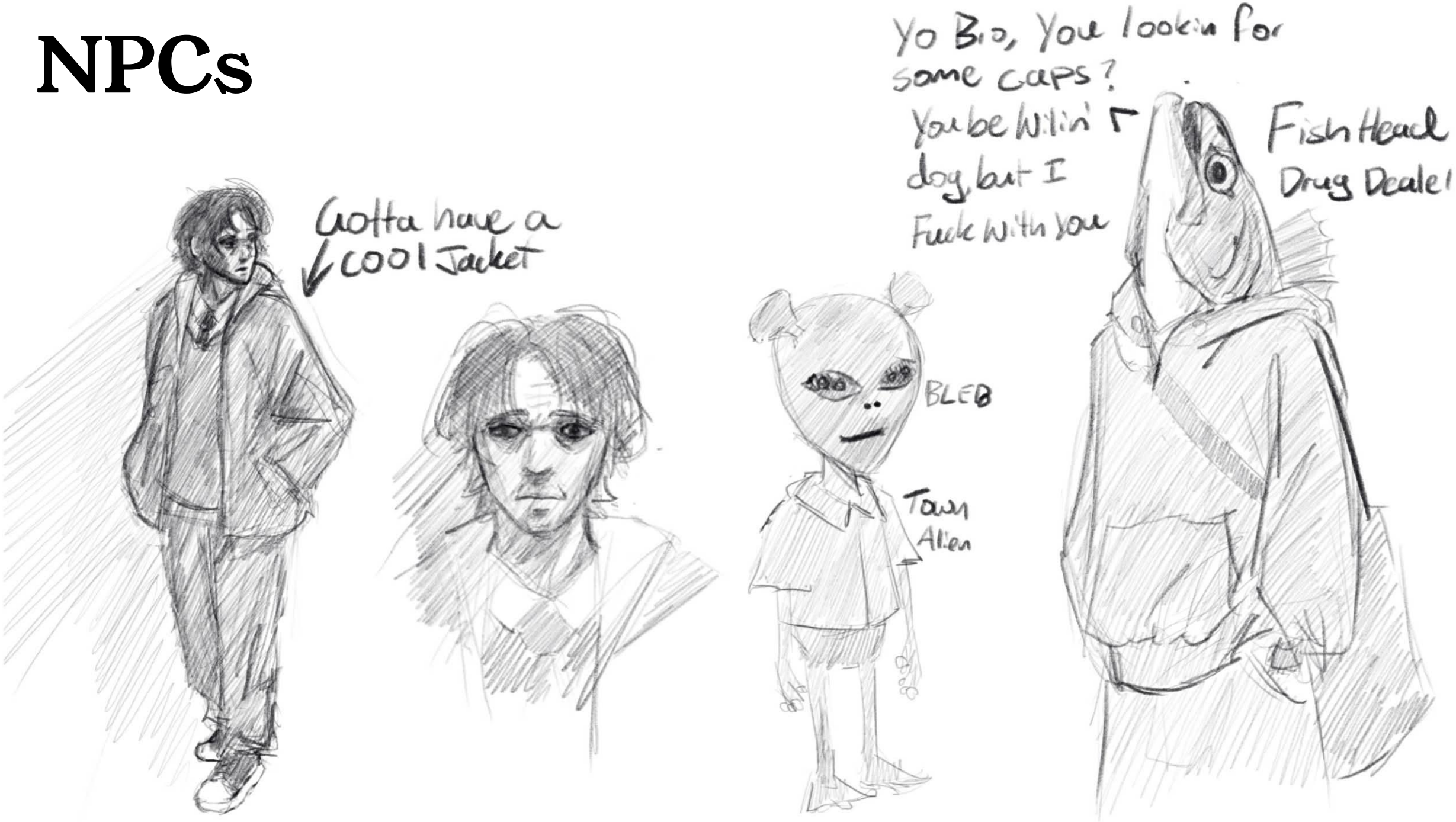
桜ケ丘
Sakuragaoka

蕎麦処
やま路

営業時間
開店 閉店
7:00 22:30
Nozomi...

South Ashfield
Restaurant Fisel

NPCs


Gotta have a cool Jacket
BLEB
Tawn Alien
Yo Bro, You lookin for some caps?
You be Wilin' dog, but I Fuck with you
Fish Head Drug Dealer

Sound

The game will have minimal non-diegetic sound, rather opting for mostly ambient sounds of streets, breezes, waves brushing upon a shore, footsteps, creaking trees, and quiet, lonely sounds.

Characters will speak but it will not be voiced, rather a sound effect will play to indicate that they are spoken, the player character will also speak sometimes, however it will sound like the bassy sound when the game master speaks in inscription.

When music is necessary, it will consist of wispy sustained chords, incomplete progressions and simple melodies that support the atmosphere. Reserved for only important moments in the game

Challenges

***If this game were to be picked**

***-I have never made a 3D game before**

***-I have never 3D Modeled assets before**

***-I don't remember much about UE5, although enthusiastic to learn.**

***-Some ideas are subject to change over the course of development, I think feeling the game in real time is important to the creative process.**

***-I'm bad at judging whether this game is too high scope for this project, I suppose that comes with starting development too.**

Thank You Very Much For Listening!!!